AR 2EB

ALAMEDA RESEARCH
2: ELECTRIC BOOGALOO
LONG HORIZONS · STRUCTURAL SHIFTS · IMAGINATION

INTERNAL RESEARCH · MEMO · NOT INVESTMENT ADVICE · AI-ASSISTED

Nautilus Biotechnology

NASDAQ : NAUT · Young-Company DCF (Damodaran)

22 July 2026 · the qualitative

$1.71

$215M mkt cap · 126M sh · $143M cash, zero debt

THE CENTRAL QUESTION

Will Nautilus capture meaningful share of a $130B global proteomics TAM by 2036 with its Voyager single-molecule platform — or does today's ~$215M market cap, now de-rated toward the cash floor, still price commercial economics that the late-2026 launch and early-2027 instrument installations haven't yet earned?

NAUT trades at $1.71 (~$215M mkt cap, ~66% in cash) on essentially zero revenue. The Voyager single-molecule platform: Tau Early Access since Jan 2026; commercial launch late 2026, first instrument installs early 2027, Broadscale (10B-protein mapping) H1 2027. Cash runway through 2027; dilutive raise likely 2027. Mature peers — Olink (Thermo), SomaScan (Illumina), Quantum-Si, mass spec — anchor terminal margins and TAM. Young-company DCF: TAM × margin × P(fail). Five scenarios, weighted; show your work.

PROBABILITY-WEIGHTED EXPECTED VALUE

$6.58 expected fair value today
+284.6% vs spot $1.71

FORWARD COMPOUNDED VALUE

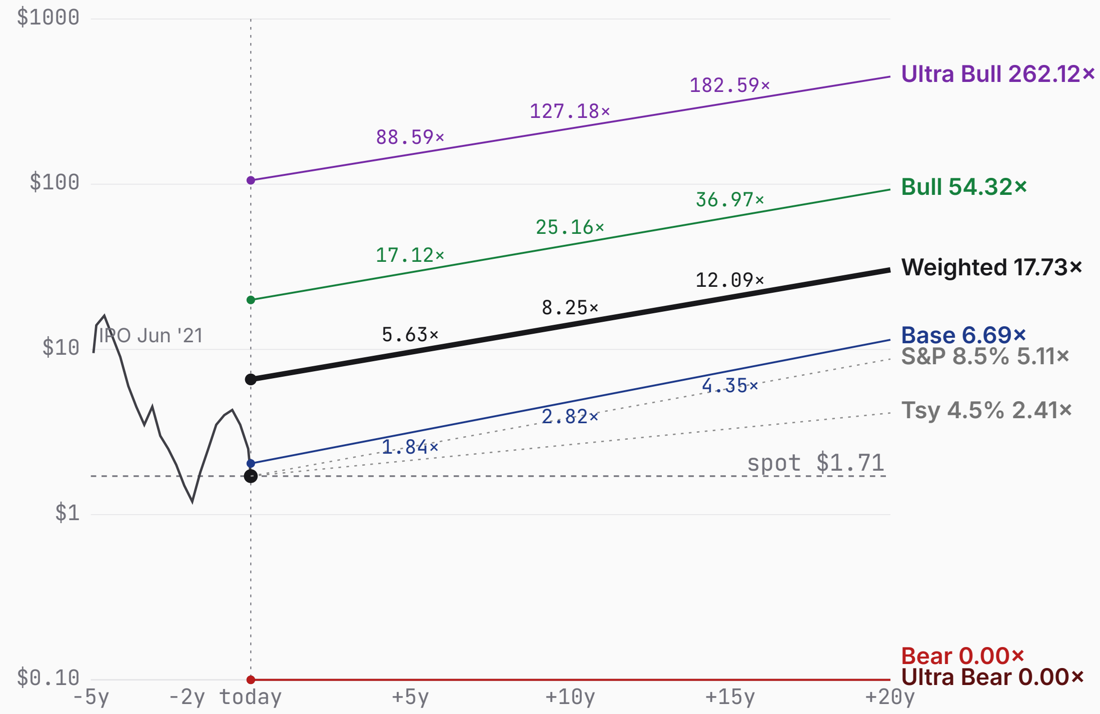
+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$9.63	$14.10	$20.67	$30.31
5.63× spot	8.25× spot	12.09× spot	17.73× spot

WEIGHTING RATIONALE

Ultra Bear 20% Deepest tail: single-molecule never validates commercially; equity wiped under full dilution.
Bear 15% Single-molecule stays a research niche; entrenched affinity competition (Olink/Thermo, SomaScan/Illumina).
Base 50% Modal: Voyager launches on schedule, ~1-2% FY36 TAM share, niche-but-real proteomics platform.
Bull 12% Compound conditional: single-molecule wins proteoform race; Tau success catalyzes mainstream adoption.
Ultra Bull 3% Tail of tails: dominant proteomics + multiomics + software-take-rate + platform re-rating.

Bull (12%) + Ultra Bull (3%) together contribute $5.56 — 84% of the $6.58 expected value despite 15% combined probability. Today's spot ($1.71) sits 74% below the weighted expected; forward-weighted value crosses spot between +5y and +10y.

PRICE + PROJECTIONS · HISTORICAL THROUGH PROBABILITY-WEIGHTED FORWARD



ULTRA BEAR	BEAR	BASE	BULL	ULTRA BULL
$0.00	$0.00	$2.04	$19.93	$105.52
-100.0% vs spot	-100.0% vs spot	+19.3% vs spot	+1065.5% vs spot	+6070.8% vs spot
TAM 0.3% P(fail) 52% S2C 0.7 Prob 20%	TAM 0.5% P(fail) 40% S2C 0.7 Prob 15%	TAM 1.2% P(fail) 18% S2C 1.0 Prob 50%	TAM 2.1% P(fail) 8% S2C 1.4 Prob 12%	TAM 4.2% P(fail) 3% S2C 1.6 Prob 3%
Platform fails to validate; deepest wipeout.	Capital exhausts; equity wiped.	Niche-but-real proteomics player.	Single-molecule wins proteoforms.	Dominant + multiomics + take-rate.

AR 2EB | ALAMEDA RESEARCH 2: ELECTRIC BOOGALOO — LONG HORIZONS · STRUCTURAL SHIFTS · IMAGINATION

Nautilus Biotechnology scenario narratives

PROBABILITY WEIGHTS

Ultra Bear 20% Bear 15% Base 50% Bull 12% Ultra Bull 3% · Weighted expected $6.58 (+284.6% vs spot)

ULTRA BEAR $0.00

-100.0% vs spot

Probability 20%

Platform fails to validate; deepest wipeout.

WHY 20%

The deepest-failure tail, separated from the bear so the downside is not one undifferentiated bucket (the convention across the rest of the book). 20% weight reflects genuine technical / competitive failure risk for a pre-revenue single-molecule platform whose Voyager launch already slipped and whose competitors (Olink at Thermo, SomaScan at Illumina, mass spec) are entrenched. Distinct from the bear (which reaches sub-scale $0.60B but is diluted to zero): here the platform fails outright. Within-scenario 52% p_fail captures Nautilus-specific bankruptcy / wind-down risk at the extreme.

WHAT HAPPENS

The catastrophic tail: Voyager's single-molecule chemistry fails to validate at commercial scale at all. Tau Early Access (2026-27) surfaces disqualifying reproducibility or throughput limits, Broadscale never ships at spec, and customers reject the platform outright for Olink / SomaScan affinity assays and mass spec. Revenue stalls near zero — about $0.30B by FY36, under 0.25% of the $130B proteomics TAM.

NAUT still raises the ~$1.1B of dilutive capital trying to reach commercial scale (126M to ~1.78B shares, 93% dilution), but the money is spent against a platform that never gains traction — the worst combination of full dilution and a failed product. Operating EV is deeply negative with no self-sustaining FCF base, so the terminal carries negative going-concern value rather than the bear's floored-at-zero.

BEAR $0.00

-100.0% vs spot

Probability 15%

Capital exhausts; equity wiped.

WHY 15%

Pre-revenue single-molecule platforms face a stack of risks the public market knows well — IPO'd peers show the path is hard (Olink acquired by Thermo at a premium; SomaLogic merged into Standard BioTools at a discount, then acquired by Illumina in Jan 2026 — so both affinity incumbents now carry a giant's global distribution; Quantum-Si still pre-revenue). NAUT-specific: Voyager's late-2026 launch already slipped; the Jan 2026 Early Access Program is real but narrow (Tau proteoforms first); $143M cash extends the runway through 2027, and commercial scale-up requires a 2027 dilutive raise. Bear case is structural — tech doesn't scale beyond niche, or proteoform analysis stays a research curiosity rather than a clinical workhorse. 15% weight (the deeper-failure 20% now sits in the ultra-bear, so combined downside is 35%): NAUT is one stage earlier than JOBY, with a smaller cash buffer and more direct competition. Within-scenario 40% p_fail captures Nautilus-specific bankruptcy risk.

WHAT HAPPENS

The pessimistic case is structural. Voyager's single-molecule resolution doesn't deliver at commercial scale: Tau Early Access data through 2026-27 surfaces reproducibility or throughput limitations that cap broader adoption. Broadscale (H1 2027) slips or underwhelms. Customers default to affinity platforms (Olink at Thermo, SomaScan at Illumina) for routine proteomics and to mass spec for high-end research, leaving single-molecule proteomics as a research-niche curiosity.

To maintain solvency through commercial launch, NAUT raises ~$1.1B cumulatively at $0.40-2.00/share — successive dilutive rounds at falling prices as the equity story deteriorates. Share count balloons from 126M to ~1.78B (93% dilution). By FY36 NAUT reaches just 0.5% of the $130B proteomics TAM — $600M revenue at 8% margin, profitable but tiny relative to the diluted share count.

BASE $2.04

+19.3% vs spot

Probability 50%

Niche-but-real proteomics player.

WHY 50%

Modal outcome. Voyager launches on or near schedule (late 2026 pre-orders, early 2027 installations); proteoform assay portfolio expands to 5-10 assays by 2030; installed base reaches 500-1000 instruments by 2030. NAUT reaches ~1-2% share of the $130B FY36 proteomics TAM — meaningful but not dominant. Mature operating margin ~15-18% — between commodity tools (~10%) and high-margin specialty diagnostics (~25%). Dilution from ~$1.08B of 2027-2029 raises at $3-14/share lands at ~57% total. The 50% weight reflects that this is the modal outcome — most realistic for a strong technical team executing on a long timeline, but not requiring breakthrough commercial dominance against entrenched affinity-platform competitors (Olink/Thermo, SomaScan/Illumina). Base case is well-executed but stays a niche player; multiple stays compressed.

WHAT HAPPENS

The middle path. Voyager launches on or near the late-2026 schedule; pre-orders convert to $5-15M of revenue in 2027 from early adopters (academic + select biopharma). The Tau proteoforms assay drives Alzheimer's research adoption — a credible biomarker hook into a large neuroscience research market. A second proteoform assay extends utility. Broadscale (H1 2027) opens the addressable market beyond niche use cases without yet displacing affinity platforms for routine work.

Through 2028-2030, the installed base grows from ~100 instruments to ~500. Average revenue per instrument settles at $250-400K/yr (instrument + consumables + assay subscriptions). NAUT raises ~$1.08B cumulatively at $3-14/share to fund commercial scale-up, lifting share count to ~293M (57% dilution). Operating margin crosses zero by 2030 and scales toward 16% by 2036 — between commodity tools and specialty diagnostics.

BULL $19.93

+1065.5% vs spot

Probability 12%

Single-molecule wins proteoforms.

WHY 12%

Compound conditional: Voyager establishes single-molecule resolution as the new gold standard for proteoform analysis (40-50% conditional on execution) AND Tau success drives Alzheimer's research/biomarker mainstream adoption (50%) AND assay portfolio expands to 10-15+ proteoforms by 2030 (60% conditional) AND mature margins reach 20-25% (40% conditional) AND the market gives NAUT credit via acquisition or re-rating (50%). Joint at 10-15%, reflected at 12%. The bull requires conjunctive execution AND a favorable backdrop where affinity platforms (Olink at Thermo, SomaScan at Illumina) don't simply absorb the single-molecule frontier. 12% (vs JOBY's 12%): structurally similar compound venture-bet, but a clearer near-term path (launch ~6 months out vs JOBY's still-pending Type Certification).

WHAT HAPPENS

The bull case is that single-molecule resolution becomes the new gold standard for proteoform analysis. Tau success — FDA biomarker validation, mainstream adoption in Alzheimer's drug development — catalyzes broader category acceptance. Broadscale (H1 2027) delivers on the 10B-protein-mapping promise; customers adopt Voyager as the routine high-resolution workhorse alongside (not replacing) Olink and SomaScan.

By 2030, NAUT operates 2,000+ instruments globally at $300-500K/yr each (instrument + reagents + assay subscriptions). Assay catalog expands from 2 to 15+ proteoform assays. Pharma partnerships drive multi-year recurring revenue. Operating margin reaches 22% by FY36 as software/assay mix shifts to higher-margin recurring revenue. NAUT becomes an obvious acquisition target for Thermo / Danaher / Bruker at premium multiples — or remains independent at platform-tools scale.

ULTRA BULL $105.52

+6070.8% vs spot

Probability 3%

Dominant + multiomics + take-rate.

WHY 3%

Tail of tails: requires every Bull condition to hit AND multiomics integration becomes routine (proteomics + sequencing + cell biology fused as the new research and diagnostic standard) AND NAUT captures dominant share at 4%+ of $130B TAM AND software-economics emerge via instrument-as-a-service / assay-take-rate model AND multiple re-rates from tools to platform. Each individually 30-50% conditional on the prior; joint at 2-4%. Captures the scenario where NAUT joins the platform-tools tier (Thermo / Danaher / Illumina) rather than remaining a niche tools player. 3% weight matches JOBY's ultra-bull pattern (genuine tail-of-tails reflecting compound conditional + market re-rating).

WHAT HAPPENS

The ultra-bull case requires Voyager to become the dominant single-molecule proteomics platform AND for multiomics integration (proteomics + sequencing + cell biology) to emerge as the standard for both research and diagnostics. By 2030 NAUT operates 5,000+ instruments globally. By 2034, an instrument-as-a-service / assay-take-rate model emerges with software-economics on a meaningful fraction of revenue — the Mobileye/Illumina platform-take-rate analog. This "multiomics becomes routine" leg is now openly contested: Illumina — which acquired SomaScan in Jan 2026 — is pairing affinity proteomics with its sequencing installed base and DRAGEN software to originate the same platform Power, so the conditional is more likely to occur but less likely to be NAUT-captured (probability held at the 3% tail floor).

Compound conditional: Voyager wins the single-molecule race (30% conditional on Tau success) AND multiomics becomes routine (40% conditional on platform success) AND NAUT captures dominant share at 4%+ of $130B TAM (25% conditional on both) AND multiple expansion from tools to platform (50% conditional on all above). Joint at 1.5-3%. Reflected here at 3%.

INTERNAL RESEARCH · MEMO · NOT INVESTMENT ADVICE · AI-ASSISTED

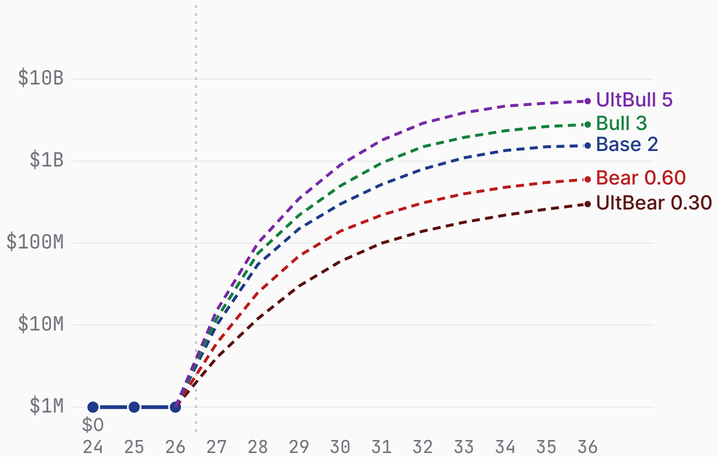
22 July 2026 · the snapshot

Nautilus Biotechnology business snapshot

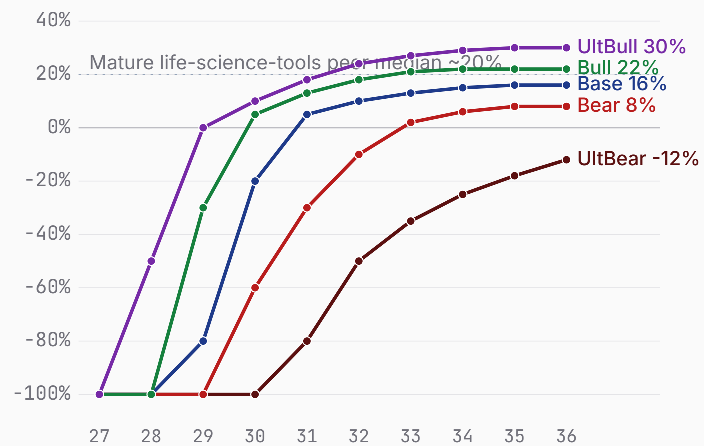
Bear $0.00 Base $2.04 Bull $19.93

FY24-FY26 history + FY27-FY36 scenario projections · fiscal years end Dec 31 · Q1 2026 10-Q, Voyager press releases, peer market cap data

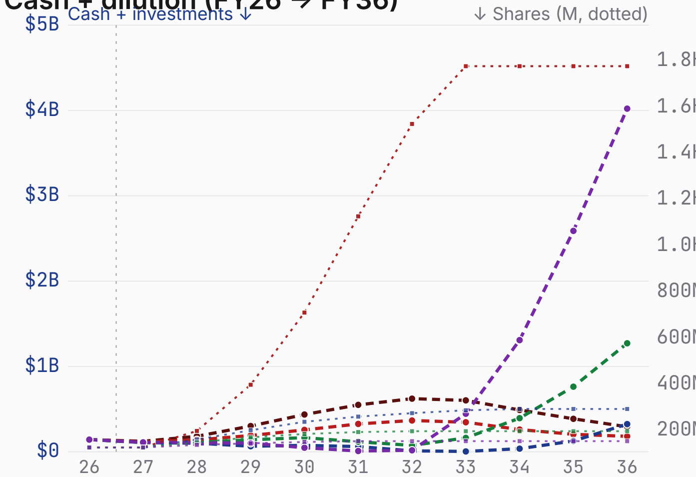
Revenue — history + scenarios to FY36 (log)



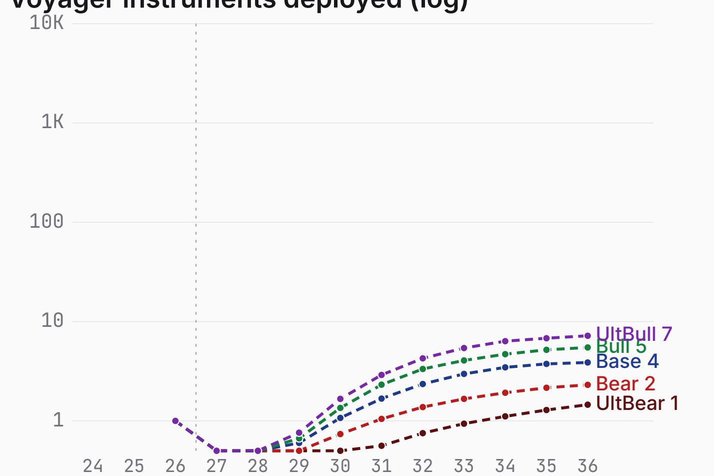
Path to profitability — op margin (FY27→FY36)



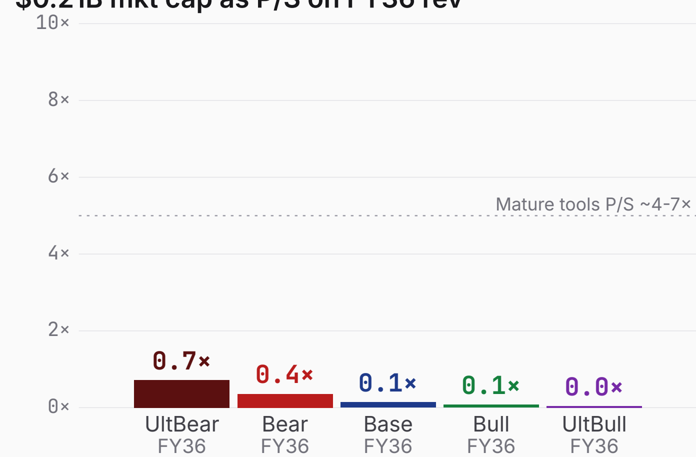
Cash + dilution (FY26 → FY36)



Voyager instruments deployed (log)

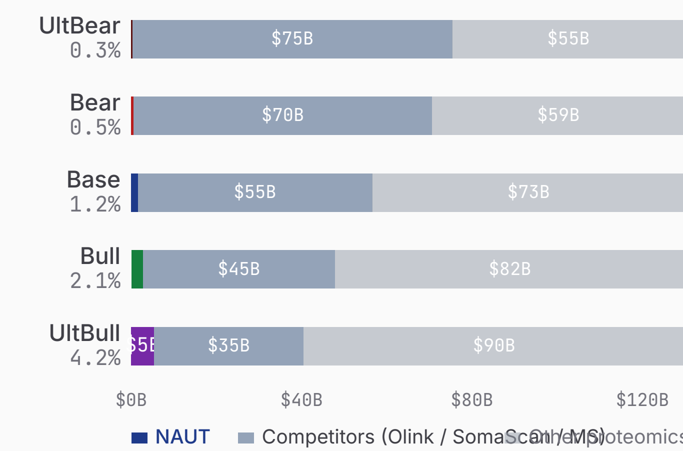


$0.21B mkt cap as P/S on FY36 rev



Bear, base = stretched on FY36 niche-rev; bull onward = cheap.

$130B global proteomics TAM (FY36) — NAUT share



Sources: NAUT 10-K FY25, Q1 2026 10-Q, Voyager Early Access Program press releases (Jan 2026), MarketsandMarkets proteomics market sizing 2030-2035, peer transaction data (Olink/Thermo, SomaLogic/Illumina).

Nautilus Biotechnology 7 Powers · the moat, scored

Bear $0.00 Base $2.04 Bull $19.93

Arena. Broad-scale proteomics — Nautilus's single-molecule protein-analysis platform vs Seer, Olink/Thermo, SomaLogic/Illumina, Quantum-Si; the race to high-throughput, deep proteome coverage.

POWER ORIGINATION
origination window: closing

POWER ORIGINATION · 7 POWERS

Scale Economies	Pre-revenue; no instruments placed, no consumable pull-through yet.
Network Economies	No installed base or data ecosystem yet.
Counter-Positioning	Multi-affinity-probe single-molecule decoding — distinct from mass-spec and aptamer incumbents.
Switching Costs	None until an instrument ships and labs standardize on it.
Branding	Scientific credibility; unproven commercially.
Cornered Resource · thesis leans here	Core IP on the probe-cycling decode method; well-funded cash position pre-launch.
Process Power	No manufacturing/assay learning curve yet.

THE RACE · NAMED RIVALS

Seer — public; cash-funded
~20% terminal share · Proteograph shipping with revenue; nanoparticle enrichment + MS. Apr-2026 PRECISE-SG100K biobank deployment (Proteograph + Orbitrap Astral MS, 10,000 samples) entrenches incumbent distribution while NAUT is pre-launch; Thermo's ~$3.1B Olink buyout deepens it.

Olink (Thermo Fisher) — Thermo balance sheet
~25% terminal share · Established PEA panels (~5k proteins); NGS readout; Thermo distribution.

SomaScan (Illumina) — Illumina balance sheet
~20% terminal share · Aptamer SomaScan (~11k proteins); Illumina acquired it from Standard BioTools Jan 2026 (~$425M) and is pairing it with its sequencing/DRAGEN ecosystem for workflow-integrated multiomics.

Quantum-Si — public
~10% terminal share · Semiconductor protein sequencing; guided to a Proteus commercial launch by end-2026 (roadshows underway), overlapping NAUT's late-2026 window — but a sequencing modality, not proteoform-affinity decode.

LEAD / LAG · FALSIFIERS

Commercial instrument shipping	no (pre-launch; external field unit validated) vs yes	LAGGING
Demonstrated proteome coverage	limited (dev) vs broad (~5-11k)	LAGGING
Cash runway (yrs at burn)	3 vs 3	EVEN

COMPETITIVE READ

Nautilus is originating a genuinely differentiated single-molecule platform with strong IP and a funded balance sheet, but it is pre-commercial and lags shipping rivals on every demonstrated metric; the window is open only while the cash lasts and before incumbents close the coverage gap — a launched, validated instrument is the falsifier. A second falsifier now sits above it: Illumina shipping an integrated SomaScan-plus-sequencing multiomics workflow at commercial scale before NAUT originates its take-rate model.

Nautilus Biotechnology show your work

Bear $0.00 Base $2.04 Bull $19.93 · Weighted $6.58 (+284.6%)

ULTRA BEAR $0.00

ASSUMPTIONS

TAM Year-10 ($B)	130
Mature share (%)	0.3
Mature op margin (%)	-12
Sales-to-capital	0.7
Terminal WACC (%)	12.0
Terminal growth (%)	2.0
P(failure) (%)	52
Scenario probability (%)	20

10-YEAR DCF · $B

FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.00	-350%	-0.02	-0.02
FY28	0.01	-250%	-0.04	-0.03
FY29	0.03	-180%	-0.08	-0.05
FY30	0.06	-120%	-0.12	-0.07
FY31	0.10	-80%	-0.14	-0.07
FY32	0.14	-50%	-0.13	-0.06
FY33	0.18	-35%	-0.12	-0.05
FY34	0.22	-25%	-0.11	-0.04
FY35	0.26	-18%	-0.10	-0.03
FY36	0.30	-12%	-0.09	-0.03

Σ PV explicit FCF	-0.44
+ PV terminal (g 2.0%)	-0.27

EQUITY BUILD · $B & PER SHARE

Operating EV	$-0.71B
+ Cash & investments	$0.14B
= Equity value	$-0.57B
Raised over period	$1.10B
Dilution by FY36	+93%
FY36 shares (M)	1,777
DCF per share	$-0.32
× (1−P_fail) [48%]	$-0.15
+ P_fail × distress [52% × $0.10]	$0.05
= Expected per share	**$0.00**

FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00
0.00×	0.00×	0.00×	0.00×

BEAR $0.00

ASSUMPTIONS

TAM Year-10 ($B)	130
Mature share (%)	0.5
Mature op margin (%)	8
Sales-to-capital	0.7
Terminal WACC (%)	11.0
Terminal growth (%)	2.0
P(failure) (%)	40
Scenario probability (%)	15

10-YEAR DCF · $B

FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.01	-300%	-0.03	-0.02
FY28	0.03	-200%	-0.08	-0.06
FY29	0.07	-120%	-0.15	-0.10
FY30	0.14	-60%	-0.18	-0.11
FY31	0.22	-30%	-0.18	-0.10
FY32	0.31	-10%	-0.16	-0.08
FY33	0.40	+2%	-0.12	-0.05
FY34	0.48	+6%	-0.09	-0.03
FY35	0.55	+8%	-0.06	-0.02
FY36	0.60	+8%	-0.02	-0.01

Σ PV explicit FCF	-0.58
+ PV terminal (g 2.0%)	0.00

EQUITY BUILD · $B & PER SHARE

Operating EV	$-0.58B
+ Cash & investments	$0.14B
= Equity value	$-0.44B
Raised over period	$1.10B
Dilution by FY36	+93%
FY36 shares (M)	1,777
DCF per share	$-0.25
× (1−P_fail) [60%]	$-0.15
+ P_fail × distress [40% × $0.15]	$0.06
= Expected per share	**$0.00**

FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00
0.00×	0.00×	0.00×	0.00×

BASE $2.04

ASSUMPTIONS

TAM Year-10 ($B)	130
Mature share (%)	1.2
Mature op margin (%)	16
Sales-to-capital	1.0
Terminal WACC (%)	9.0
Terminal growth (%)	2.5
P(failure) (%)	18
Scenario probability (%)	50

10-YEAR DCF · $B

FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.01	-250%	-0.03	-0.03
FY28	0.06	-150%	-0.13	-0.10
FY29	0.15	-80%	-0.21	-0.15
FY30	0.30	-20%	-0.21	-0.13
FY31	0.52	+5%	-0.19	-0.11
FY32	0.80	+10%	-0.20	-0.10
FY33	1.10	+13%	-0.16	-0.07
FY34	1.35	+15%	-0.05	-0.02
FY35	1.50	+16%	+0.09	+0.03
FY36	1.55	+16%	+0.20	+0.07

Σ PV explicit FCF	-0.61
+ PV terminal (g 2.5%)	1.18

EQUITY BUILD · $B & PER SHARE

Operating EV	$0.57B
+ Cash & investments	$0.14B
= Equity value	$0.71B
Raised over period	$1.08B
Dilution by FY36	+57%
FY36 shares (M)	293
DCF per share	$2.42
× (1−P_fail) [82%]	$1.98
+ P_fail × distress [18% × $0.30]	$0.05
= Expected per share	**$2.04**

FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$3.14	$4.83	$7.43	$11.43
1.84×	2.82×	4.35×	6.69×

BULL $19.93

ASSUMPTIONS

TAM Year-10 ($B)	130
Mature share (%)	2.1
Mature op margin (%)	22
Sales-to-capital	1.4
Terminal WACC (%)	8.0
Terminal growth (%)	3.0
P(failure) (%)	8
Scenario probability (%)	12

10-YEAR DCF · $B

FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.01	-200%	-0.03	-0.03
FY28	0.07	-100%	-0.12	-0.10
FY29	0.22	-30%	-0.17	-0.12
FY30	0.50	+5%	-0.17	-0.11
FY31	0.95	+13%	-0.20	-0.12
FY32	1.50	+18%	-0.12	-0.07
FY33	1.95	+21%	+0.09	+0.04
FY34	2.35	+22%	+0.23	+0.11
FY35	2.65	+22%	+0.37	+0.16
FY36	2.80	+22%	+0.51	+0.20

Σ PV explicit FCF	-0.04
+ PV terminal (g 3.0%)	4.12

EQUITY BUILD · $B & PER SHARE

Operating EV	$4.08B
+ Cash & investments	$0.14B
= Equity value	$4.22B
Raised over period	$0.75B
Dilution by FY36	+36%
FY36 shares (M)	196
DCF per share	$21.53
× (1−P_fail) [92%]	$19.81
+ P_fail × distress [8% × $1.50]	$0.12
= Expected per share	**$19.93**

FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$29.28	$43.03	$63.22	$92.89
17.12×	25.16×	36.97×	54.32×

ULTRA BULL $105.52

ASSUMPTIONS

TAM Year-10 ($B)	130
Mature share (%)	4.2
Mature op margin (%)	30
Sales-to-capital	1.6
Terminal WACC (%)	7.5
Terminal growth (%)	3.5
P(failure) (%)	3
Scenario probability (%)	3

10-YEAR DCF · $B

FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.01	-150%	-0.03	-0.03
FY28	0.10	-50%	-0.10	-0.08
FY29	0.35	+0%	-0.16	-0.11
FY30	0.90	+10%	-0.25	-0.17
FY31	1.80	+18%	-0.24	-0.14
FY32	2.90	+24%	+0.01	+0.01
FY33	3.90	+27%	+0.43	+0.22
FY34	4.70	+29%	+0.86	+0.41
FY35	5.10	+30%	+1.28	+0.57
FY36	5.40	+30%	+1.43	+0.59

Σ PV explicit FCF	+1.25
+ PV terminal (g 3.5%)	15.24

EQUITY BUILD · $B & PER SHARE

Operating EV	$16.49B
+ Cash & investments	$0.14B
= Equity value	$16.63B
Raised over period	$0.65B
Dilution by FY36	+18%
FY36 shares (M)	153
DCF per share	$108.69
× (1−P_fail) [97%]	$105.43
+ P_fail × distress [3% × $3.00]	$0.09
= Expected per share	**$105.52**

FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$151.49	$217.48	$312.22	$448.23
88.59×	127.18×	182.59×	262.12×

Nautilus Biotechnology People · Opportunity · Context · Deal

Bear $0.00 Base $2.04 Bull $19.93

Underwrite the position the way a venture investor underwrites a round — across all four legs, public or private. **People** is the leg scored here (observable only); Opportunity, Context and Deal cross-reference the rest of the memo.

PEOPLE · WHO RUNS / OWNS / FUNDS IT

Sujal Patel · founder-led

5 yrs in seat

14.8%
insider ownership

HIGH
key-person risk

Capital allocation (realized)
Pre-revenue (FY2026 revenue guided ~$0.5M, effectively zero). Q1 2026 cash & investments $143.4M (~66% of the ~$0.22B market cap); Q1 burn $12.8M (opex $16.1M, down 14% YoY); runway guided through 2027. No dividend or buyback (pre-revenue); spend is R&D on the Voyager / single-molecule proteomics platform toward commercial launch. Originally funded by a $350M SPAC/PIPE in 2021 ($200M PIPE led by Perceptive); scenarios assume additional equity raises / dilution to fund operations past 2027.

Incentive alignment
Founder-CEO holds ~14.8% beneficial economic stake (10.34M direct + 1.81M via the Sujal Patel 2020 Children's Trust + 5.28M via PFV I, LLC); bought 200,000 shares open-market Sept 2025. FY2025 total compensation ~$1.96M, equity-weighted (~27% salary). Specific PSU/TSR vs. time-based equity terms not separately disclosed in accessible sources.

GOVERNANCE FLAGS

- SPAC origin (ARYA Sciences Acquisition Corp III; closed Jun 2021)
- single class of common stock (one share = one vote; no super-voting / dual-class)
- independent Chair (Matthew Posard) separate from the CEO
- board of 9, 7 independent; 2 insiders (Patel CEO, Mallick co-founder / Chief Scientist)
- classified board — three staggered classes (an anti-takeover structure)
- insiders own ~29% of shares in aggregate
- a16z (early backer) roughly halved its stake from ~14% to ~7.1% via two June-2026 secondary blocks (5.0M shares at $2.35 on Jun 2; 3.59M at $2.00 on Jun 26; 13D/A) — secondary sales, no new dilution; a soft supply overhang, not a control/structure change

> **PEOPLE READ**
> Founder-owner-operator (~14.8%, with open-market buying in 2025) under a single-class one-share-one-vote structure, an independent Chair, and a 7-of-9 independent board — clean alignment and governance for a SPAC-origin name; the offsets are acute key-person concentration (Patel + co-founder Mallick are the platform) and a structural dilution path, the pre-revenue burn funded by equity raises beyond the 2027 runway.

THE FOUR LEGS

People ●●●●○
observable composite · 1–5

Opportunity
The scenario distribution · the business snapshot

Context
The 7 Powers analysis (Power Origination)

Deal
Open-market common — entry price weighed against the probability-weighted fair value (the +285% finding at the $1.71 spot), then position-sized.

Nautilus Biotechnology supporting analysis · disclaimers · glossary

Bear $0.00 Base $2.04 Bull $19.93

PUSHBACK · WHY THE BASE CASE IS TOO HARSH

1. **Best-funded single-molecule platform.** $143M cash, zero debt, cost discipline (16% headcount cut, Q1 burn $12.8M). Runway through 2027. Peers are less funded relative to need.
2. **Early Access is real, not vaporware.** Tau proteoforms EAP live since Jan 2026, now externally validated — Buck Institute field-tested a Voyager; Baylor is first Iterative Mapping EAP customer.
3. **First-mover in proteoform single-molecule.** Quantum-Si is sequencing-focused; affinity platforms (Olink/SomaScan) target a different modality. NAUT leads time-to-market in proteoforms.
4. **Tau strategic positioning.** Alzheimer's biomarker market $10B+; proteoform analysis is what makes Tau actionable. Single-product launch anchors adoption in a large research market.
5. **Cash floor is real downside protection.** $1.13/share cash vs $1.71 spot = ~66% of mkt cap is liquid. Operating EV ~$0.57/share for a real platform. Hard to lose money permanently here.

FALSIFICATION TRIGGERS

Bear validation

Voyager pre-orders < $10M by Q1 2027 · Cash < $80M EOY 2027 · Broadscale slips to 2028+ · Tau EAP count flat YoY · a dilutive raise below ~$2 — now armed (spot $1.71); watch the ~$125M S-3 ATM and Q2 (Jul 28 2026).

Bull validation

Pre-orders > $30M by Q1 2027 · 100+ instruments installed EOY 2027 · second pharma/OEM partnership · multi-year take-rate deal disclosed

Reframe needed

Quantum-Si guided Proteus to a commercial launch by end-2026, overlapping NAUT's late-2026 window; a cheaper/faster rival erodes NAUT's edge. QSI: sequencing, not proteoform decode.

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GLOSSARY · CONCEPTS REFERENCED IN THE NARRATIVE

Voyager — NAUT's single-molecule proteomics platform — instrument + reagents + assays + software for proteoform analysis.

Proteoforms — Protein variants from a single gene (post-translational modifications, splice variants). Single-molecule readout resolves these vs ensemble methods.

Tau — Microtubule-associated protein; key Alzheimer's biomarker. Tau proteoform analysis is NAUT's first commercial assay, live in Early Access since Jan 2026.

Early Access Program — Limited release to academic + biopharma partners ahead of general availability. Live since Jan 2026 (Tau assay); expands to Broadscale H1 2027.

Broadscale — Voyager's planned 10-billion-protein-mapping capability for general proteomics, scheduled for H1 2027 general availability.

S2C (sales-to-capital) — Damodaran reinvestment ratio. ΔRevenue / S2C = reinvestment in $. NAUT case ranges 0.7-1.7 (capital-light hardware-software blend).